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The Spokesman

Official Newsletter of the Badger Heritage Chapter
Antique Motorcycle Club of America

Fall - September 15, 2026

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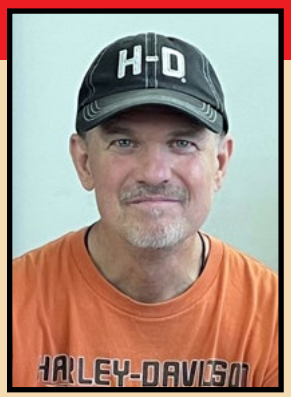
Badger Heritage Chapter
FALL MEETING
Saturday, October 10, 2026 - Noon

Cover Photo by Chris Gunns

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Presidents Message

Jon D. Oeflein - President



Hello Badgers,

Another fantastic season of vintage moto events is almost in the books! Of all our activities so far, I am especially proud of Bikes, Bourbon and BBQ which was at Davidson Park on July the 18th. I worked with Harley-Davidson, The H-D Foundation and the H-D Museum in a coordinated effort to put this thing together. We ended up with 45 vintage H-Ds and everyone got a free entry ticket to the H-D Museum, a gift certificate to the H-D gift store, a free BBQ pass and a Badger towel. The BBQ was amazing and we all had a blast!



I am also pleased with the success of the Summer Picnic. This is the first time we have had an event at Wade Mueller and Cathy Drexler's farm and all went very well. The weather was not looking promising, but in the end it turned out to be a beautiful day. Wade made a sausage boil and I made a chicken/tomato crock dish. We also had cole slaw, fresh bread, chips and cookies. We decided to prepare enough food for 150. This turned out to be a good call because attendance was awesome! Everyone ate well.

We were going to have the meeting in the barn, but the temperature had risen into the eighties. With the large crowd we decided things would work better outside. A big thanks to Tom Hinderholtz for moving his brother's sound system at the last minute. The extra work was worth it and the meeting went smoothly in front of the barn. I also want to thank Boz and Dani for working the check-in table. As well as Joe Bosman for making an emergency store run and everyone else who helped out. Of course, the big thanks goes to Wade and Drex.

We are down to the last event of 2026 which is our Fall Meeting. Steve Schwoegler and Maggie Banks have volunteered to host at their new place in Caledonia. See the poster in this issue for all the details. The Fall Meetings are always important because this is when we elect our officers. Our elected positions come with two year terms and at this meeting the chapter will decide on the future President and Treasurer.

After serving the chapter for twelve consecutive years, eight as VP and four as President, I have decided that I will not be seeking another term. I discussed this decision at the Summer Picnic and I will again at the Fall Meeting. Basically, I feel I have given the chapter my best and it is now time for some new blood to take the reins. I love the chapter and plan on remaining active, but not in a leadership position. I will also be stepping aside as one of the managers of our social media.

Boz has also decided not to run for another term as our Treasurer. He will explain his decision at the Fall Meeting. He has done a fantastic job and will also continue as an active Badger member. Kevin Klatt and Mark Hurst are also not seeking to be appointed as Advisors again. They too should be thanked by everyone for jobs well done.

This is a chance for YOU to get involved in leadership. All of our chapter's growth and success has been at the hands of volunteers! Let's keep the chapter on the roll it has been on for the last decade plus! If you have any interest please reach out to any of the officers and we would be happy to discuss all that goes along with each of the open positions. I have gotten great satisfaction from serving the chapter and I think you would as well!

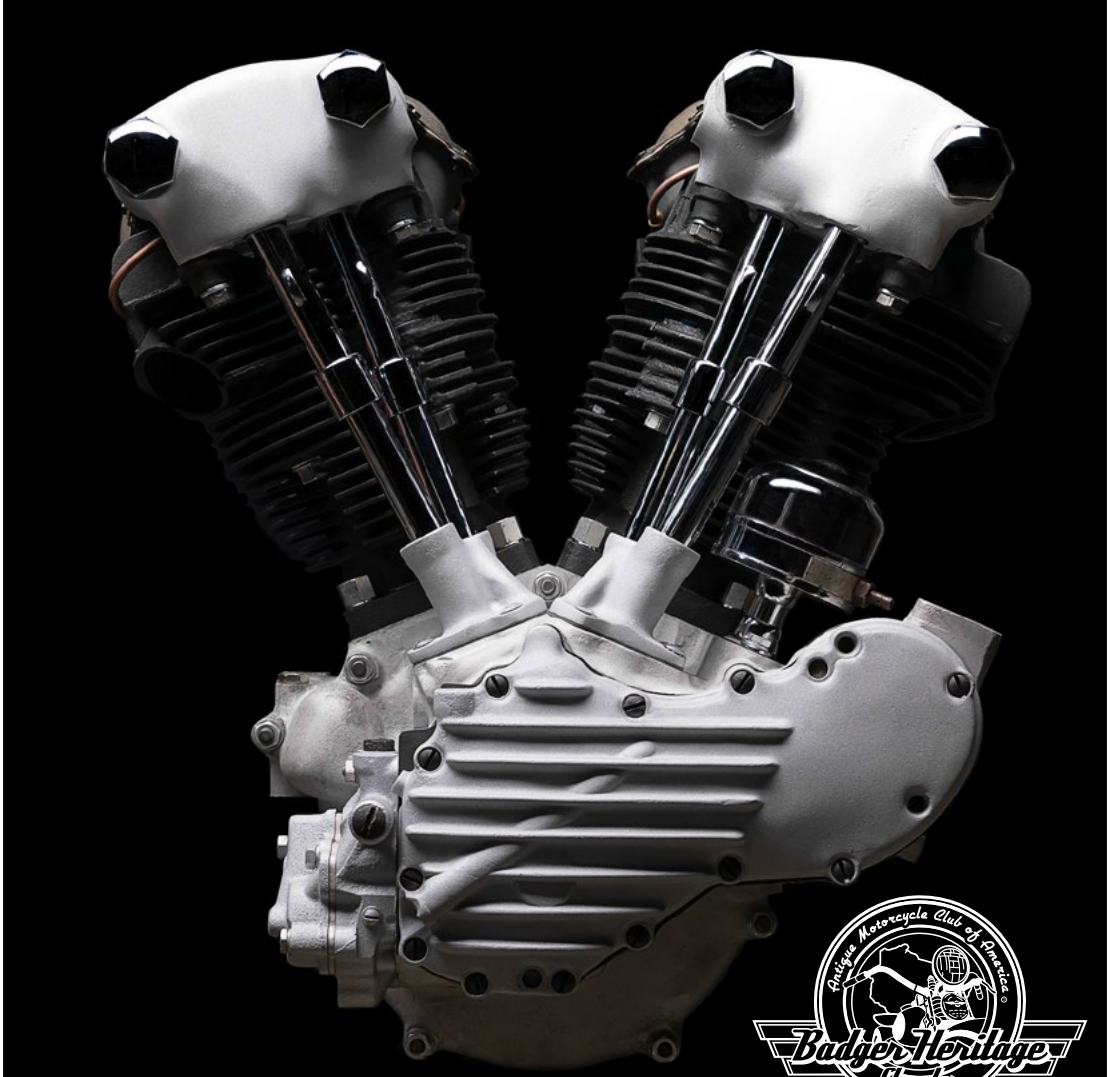
Hope to see you soon!

Your pres, Jono

Badger Heritage Chapter

FALL MEETING

Saturday, October 10, 2026 - Noon



Fun - Food - Drinks - Goodfellowship

Officer Elections

Full complimentary lunch and soft drinks will be served to all current members!

Steve Schwoegler and Maggie Banks' Place - 13032 7-1/2 Mile Road, Caledonia, Wisconsin, 53108

NO RSVP REQUIRED

Vice Presidents Message

Chris Tribbey - Vice President



Greetings from your VP,

Wow the summer is sure flying by. Lots of rides going on and almost too much to do it all. I have been busy on the swap meet circuit and curently am writing this from Davenport, IA for the big swap meet weekend. I know a lot of Badgers will be here and it will be good seeing many of you.

The turnout for Milwaukee Mike's celbration of life was overwhelming. Mike made quite an impression on so many people and it was GREAT to see all those that attended to pay tribute to a great man.

The summer meeting/lunch at Wade and Drex's farm was incredible. Over 100 in attendance, with some new faces and some new members. The food was outstanding. Thanks again Wade and Drex! At the meeting, Jon discussed the importance of the fall meeting. It will be the last meeting of the year and still be able to ride our bikes. The most important issue at this meeting will be elections for President and Treasurer. Only members present are allowed to vote; so your attendance is really crucial. If any of you are considering running and have questions, feel free to each out to any of the officers and advisors. We will also be appointing two new advisors and if you would like to be considered, let an officer know.

Our chapter is growing with great members and I am a proud Badger! Looking forward to seeing you all at the Fall meeting if not before.

See you down the road!

Chris Tribbey
VP, Badger Heritage



74 CUBIC INCH OHV MODEL

Acceleration and power in abundance feature this new model. Ideal for sidecar service or solo use where "lightning-like" acceleration is desirable. Motors will average above 50 horsepower.

From the Desk of the Newsletter Editor

Old Bike Repairs by Steve Peters





Hey Badgers!

I'm sure all of you know that having an old motorcycle requires constant maintenance. Some of it I can do myself and some I cannot because of a lack of knowledge or tools and equipment needed to make the repairs or other needed updates.

Having the same bike for nearly 35 years I have become quite familiar with its little quirks and issues that need to be watched and adjusted as needed or in some instances, just let them go and live with it the way it is. I have had others ride my Sporty once in a while and some of them will point out a problem or other thing that they see as an issue, but to me it is just normal and don't worry about it. Those that have mentioned this sort of thing the most are the ones that do motorcycle repair and are more used to things being correct and expect the problems to be fixed. That may be because they do that for a living, have the space and tools to take care of the issues plus the knowledge to do it.

I don't always have the space, tools or knowledge and sometimes need to rely on others to help me.

I feel very fortunate to be in such a group as the Badger Heritage Chapter because of the many benefits of the organization and the great members, with one of those benefits being the tremendous knowledge base. Besides having many members being able to help with problems by just asking, we do have several that actually make it their business to do motorcycle repair and I have taken my bike or parts to a few of them. But, before I mention who, let me give you couple other stories of other attempts at repair or parts acquisition.

I recall going to Milwaukee Harley-Davidson one time about 20 years ago looking for a brake light switch for the rear brake on my 1974 Sportster. They used the same plunger type of switch for many years so they were quite plentiful at the time, but apparently not purchased very often. When the clerk brought the box for the needed switch to the counter, he actually blew the dust off of the box and said they don't have much call for that particular switch. Upon looking at the date of manufacture on the official orange and black Harley-Davidson box, it indicated it was sitting on their shelf for 18 years.

Another instance from around the same time, I took my Sporty to the House of Harley-Davidson to have new rear brakes installed and after I paid for them, I was told that in the shop the foreman asked all of the crew to take a look at the brakes as some of the younger guys had never seen drum brakes and he used the install as a teaching moment for the old technology.

One more time at the House of Harley-Davidson about 10 years ago I was not as fortunate. Again I needed some work on the Sporty, but only the wheels. I had two wheels, one with a tire and one without. My plan was to just have the tire taken off one rim and put on the other one – very simple for a shop such as theirs. When I took the two wheels into the shop to have the work done, I was asked what year bike they were for. When I answered, 1974, the guy immediately stated that they would not work on bikes that old. Seriously? It was only the wheels, nothing else. Not a carburetor, or drum brakes, or any other part that may have changed over the years making my needed work to be so out of date that they didn't have the tools or knowledge to fix the problem. Maybe I should have said 2000 something and they would have not known the difference. That was the last time I went to a new bike dealership for service.

Being a Badger, I will always patronize my fellow members including those that I have had work on my bike in the past – Willie Kiefert at Willie's R&R Service, Charlie Schroepfer at Competition Cycle, and Chris Tribbey at Bike Works. I know they very much enjoy working on old bikes and they only ask what year my bike is because they want to get the correct parts, not because it's too old. Also, they all are very dedicated to their work and I know it will be done correctly every time.

Take care and stay safe!

Steve Peters

In Memoriam
Badger Kurt Douglas Klokkenga - 11/30/56 - 8/6/26



Kurt Douglas Klokkenga, 69, of Emden, IL, passed away on August 6, 2026, in Hill City, South Dakota. He was born November 30, 1956, in Lincoln, IL, the son of Robert and Virginia (Behrends) Klokkenga of Hartsburg, IL. Kurt graduated from Western Illinois University in 1978.

While he appreciated motorcycles of all kinds, his heart belonged especially to antique and vintage motorcycles. What began as an interest became a defining part of his life. His knowledge, willingness to help, and genuine passion for riding made him someone others could count on. Kurt was the kind of enthusiast who did not simply admire old motorcycles—he understood them, worked on them, rode them, and helped keep their history alive.

His involvement in long-distance vintage motorcycle events included serving as part of the motorcycle sweep crew for the Motorcycle Cannonball, helping riders and their machines along the way. His friendships within the motorcycle community extended far beyond Illinois and became an important part of his life. But for all that motorcycles meant to Kurt, his greatest joy was found in the people he loved. Kurt and Regina Washam Klokkenga were married for a year and a half, but those who knew them often spoke of the depth of their relationship as though they had been together much longer. Their marriage was a source of great happiness for Kurt.

Kurt will be remembered not only for the motorcycles he restored, rode, and cherished, but for the stories, friendships, knowledge, and generosity he shared along the way. To those in the vintage motorcycle community, he was a respected and valued friend. To his family, he was a brother, father, uncle, cousin, and husband whose place in their lives can never be replaced.

Kurt and Regina's lives ended together, leaving behind a family and a community grieving two lives that brought tremendous love and joy to those fortunate enough to know them.

In Memoriam
Badger Regina Kay Klokkenga - 4/1/56 - 8/6/26



Regina Kay Klokkenga, 69, of Emden, passed away on Thursday, August 6, 2026 in Hill City, South Dakota. She was born on April 1, 1957, in Lincoln, IL, the daughter of Robert and Betty (Coombs) Washam. Regina graduated from Lincoln High School in 1975.

Regina held various careers throughout her life, with her favorites being a florist at Kroger and a travel agent for Astro Travel. Both of these careers allowed her to tap into her creative mind. In early 2020, she retired from AT&T. Dance was always a passion in her life and being able to channel that into yoga was second nature to her. Together with her daughter Nikki, they created The Soulful Wellness Collective in Lincoln. Regina was a natural healer, simply by her presence.

She could light up a room or a person's day through her smile alone or with a big hug. Her many joys in life were the friendships she made, gardening, decorating, and riding. Of all the many roles Regina had, by far her favorite was being a mother. Her love for nature and the outdoors was shared with her kids as she would take them on annual camping trips, kayaking or starting a quality campfire.

Regina married Kurt Klokkenga on December 12, 2024 at 12:00pm in Paul's Grove at The Ranch. They both were very proud of being married on 12/12 at 12pm. Although Regina and Kurt were only married for a short while, their love was as if they lived a lifetime together. Regina quickly took to the open road with Kurt and began traveling everywhere with him. They enjoyed the open road on one of their antique motorcycles and of course their bright red camper van. While they enjoyed traveling anywhere and everywhere, what meant the most was the people they traveled to see.

Regina will be remembered as one who shined love onto everyone, brought peace to a room and for always greeting people with a smile. Her care for animals, deep love for her family, and her creative self expression. She is a person who is remembered by how she made you feel.

Chapter Summer Picnic - Lowell, WI - 8/15/26

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



Additional Photos by Ken Bosman (Boz)





Saturday, August 15 arrived, and it was time for the Badgers AMCA Summer Meeting at Wade and Drex's farm in Lowell, Wisconsin. I left Milwaukee solo on my 1976 FLH Shovelhead, heading west from the lake. The morning started a little brisk, but it quickly turned into a beautiful summer day once I got outside the city.

Rolling up the long gravel road for the first time, I immediately spotted the dirt flat track off to the right. I knew I had found the right place. I continued toward the back to park and meet up with the rest of the leadership team, who had arrived before me. My Shovelhead had given me a small hiccup on the way there, but it was running well enough at the moment and I was hopeful it would hold together for the ride home.

Before long, bikes began roaring down the gravel road. Some arrived one or two at a time, while others came rolling in as part of larger groups, including one pack of around twenty motorcycles.

As one of the younger members of the Badgers chapter, moments like that still light a spark in me. Watching a group of vintage motorcycles come through together makes me feel like a kid again and reminds me why I got into antique motorcycles and motorcycles in general.

Everyone gathered, shook hands, traded hugs, and caught up on stories while Wade prepared an incredible lunch over the fire. He cooked sausages and potatoes in a massive pot, Cajun crawfish boil style, then dumped it all out onto newspaper spread across the tables. It was a great meal, and Cathy and Wade made sure nobody left hungry.

Once we were all full, Jon opened the meeting with a short moment of silence in memory of Milwaukee Mike, as well as Kurt and Regina Klokkenga, who recently passed away.

Continued on next page.



Photo by Boz



Photo by Boz

Chapter Summer Picnic - Lowell, WI - 8/15/26

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



Additional Photos by Ken Bosman (Boz)



We then discussed the recent National AMCA Zoom meeting, including an upcoming opening on the national board for a local chapter president. We covered how the Badgers chapter is doing, upcoming events such as the 33 Ride, and the upcoming leadership transition within our chapter. Both Jon and Boz will be finishing their terms as President and Treasurer, and elections will be held at the Fall Meeting. If you are interested in running for either position, or if you want to vote, you must be present at the Fall Meeting.

Chris Tribby also made an important announcement. By the time this issue reaches you, the nomination process should be live for Milwaukee Mike Johnston to be inducted into the Sturgis Motorcycle Museum Hall of Fame in the Kickstands Down category. This is something our chapter can all help with, and it takes less than five minutes.

To submit a nomination, go to www.sturgismuseum.com/nominations and enter the following:

- Nominee name: Milwaukee Mike Johnston
- Nominee email and phone: Enter your own information
- Award: Kickstands Down
- Life dates: 8/14/68 to 5/11/26
- Nominator information: Enter your own name, email, and phone number

The next three fields ask you to write about Mike and why he deserves the recognition. Please take a few minutes to share your memories and write as much as you can. The more nominations and stories submitted, the stronger the nomination will be.

As the day began winding down, I believe I was one of the first to head out. With my wife out of town, I needed to get home to my pup, and I was also a little concerned about that earlier Shovelhead hiccup. As it turned out, I had good reason to be cautious. On the ride home, I found the issue. The rear exhaust stud had stripped out and created a leak that eventually left me stranded for a bit.

Continued on next page.



Photo by Boz



Photo by Boz

Chapter Summer Picnic - Lowell, WI - 8/15/26

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns

Additional Photos by Ken Bosman (Boz)





Thankfully, after years of riding choppers, a few frustrated phone calls, and some roadside thinking, I was able to rig it up with hose clamps well enough to get home. It was another reminder to always carry tools when riding these old machines and to keep learning everything you can about them. I continue to learn from the people in this club, and I appreciate everyone who has ever offered me help, knowledge, or advice along the way.

Overall, the Summer Badgers Meeting was an amazing day. I know many members were still out at Sturgis, but we had an excellent turnout, with roughly one third of our local chapter present, around 100 people. Thank you again to Wade and Cathy for opening up your beautiful farm, hosting the meeting, and feeding everyone.

As Advisor for the Badgers AMCA chapter, I am proud to see the friendships, knowledge, and enthusiasm that keep this group moving forward. I hope to see everyone on the road sooner rather than later. The Fall Meeting date should be announced elsewhere in this issue of the Spokesmen, so keep an eye out. If you have been thinking about stepping into a leadership role, now is the time to consider running for President or Treasurer.

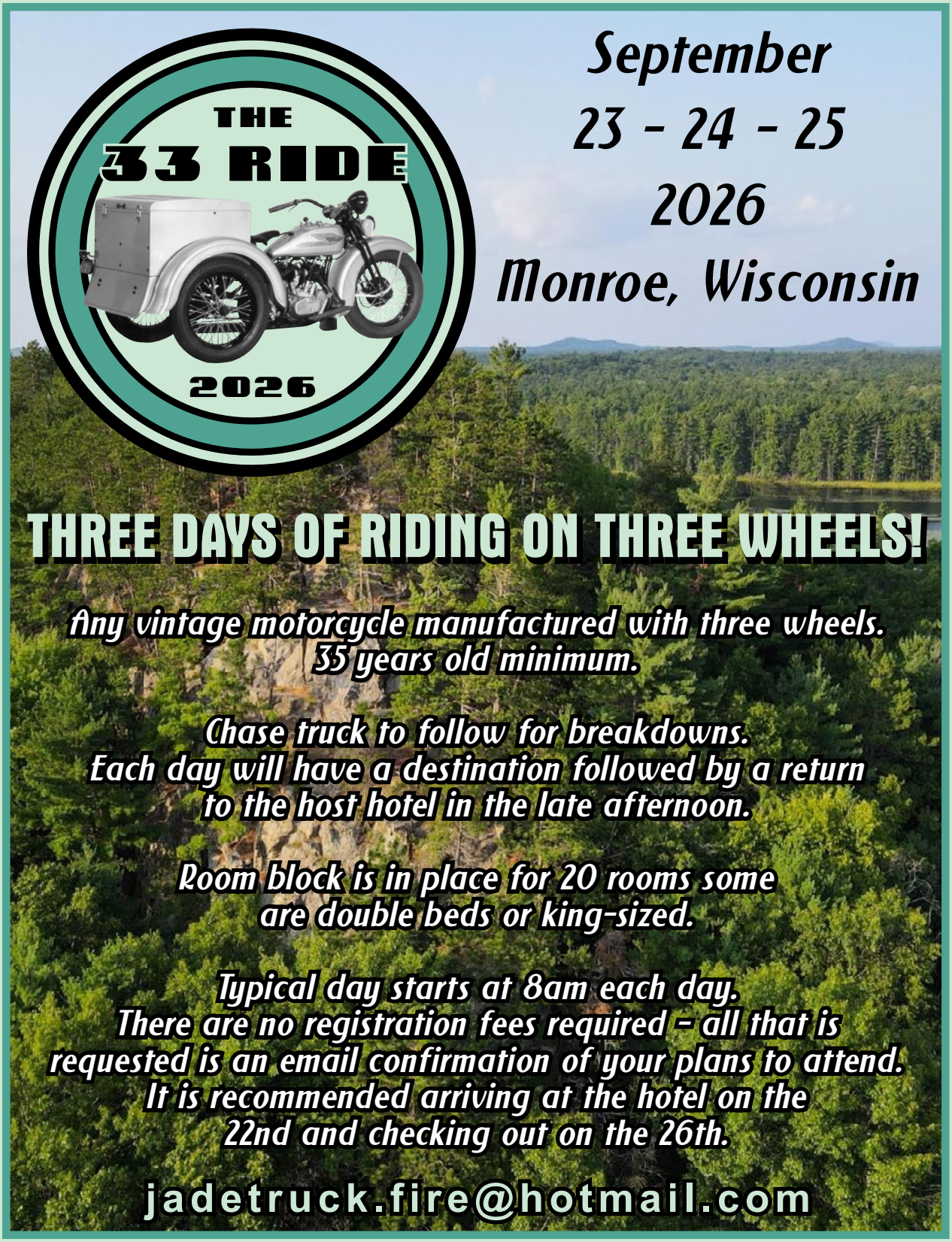
Cheers,
Gunns



Photo by Boz



Photo by Boz


THE
33 RIDE
2026
September
23 - 24 - 25
2026
Monroe, Wisconsin
THREE DAYS OF RIDING ON THREE WHEELS!
Any vintage motorcycle manufactured with three wheels.
35 years old minimum.
Chase truck to follow for breakdowns.
Each day will have a destination followed by a return
to the host hotel in the late afternoon.
Room block is in place for 20 rooms some
are double beds or king-sized.
Typical day starts at 8am each day.
There are no registration fees required - all that is
requested is an email confirmation of your plans to attend.
It is recommended arriving at the hotel on the
22nd and checking out on the 26th.
jadetruck.fire@hotmail.com

AMCA Black Hills National Road Run - Deadwood, SD - 9/8-10/26

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



The Black Hills are legendary with motorcyclists. The roads and the scenery lend themselves to the sort of exploration possible only on two wheels. As a result, the 2026 Black Hills National Road Run sold out almost immediately. In my case, I'm also a Rocky Mountain Chapter member and our annual invitation road run was scheduled immediately after the Black Hills, giving me a chance to do two, three day runs back-to-back. What biker could resist a solid week of riding the most beautiful scenery in the West?

About a dozen AMCA members, including several Badgers, did the same as me and came a few days early to Hill City to enjoy the riding. On Sunday, I took a fast, sweeping 40 mile ride past Rushmore and across several local back roads. Fun is a good word. Labor Day offered beautiful skies, open roads, and a chance to explore Custer State Park's famous Wildlife Trail Loop. I shined up my 1972 Triumph Trident, kicked him over, and off we went. To get to the Wildlife Trail I "just" had to go down the Needles Highway and then "forced" myself to return via the horribly scenic route north up Iron Mountain Road to Mt. Rushmore. Right after the 244 exchange for Rushmore is the Old Hill City Road, which is one fun way to roll 14 miles back to Hill City. It was simply a lovely day. When I returned to the hotel it was great to see about a dozen Badgers and our chapter flag flying.

The first day of riding involved a run north to Deadwood for lunch at Jerry Greer's Engineering. The shop set up in the back for our group. We had free run of the shop and it was quite fun to check out. After lunch, our return route was via Spearfish Canyon, one of the more legendary rides south from Deadwood. My riding buddy and I left out early to enjoy the road without heavy traffic. It was a great decision as we saw only three cars in a 20 mile stretch. The weather was nearly perfect and the diversity of motorbikes surprising. While American makes dominated, there was still a good representation of British, German and Italian machines. Surprisingly, the Japanese machines I spotted were Honda Ascot 500 singles from the early 1980s. Out of more than 100 bikes, only one wound up being trailered back. My buddy and I rolled a few more miles than the main group, racking just under 180 miles for the day.

Continued on next page







AMCA Black Hills National Road Run - Deadwood, SD - 9/8-10/26

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



Day two dawned with gorgeous blue skies and temperatures in the low 70s. The route card was largely a repeat of the solo ride I took before the rally, with a run on the Needles Highway, Iron Mountain Road, and the Custer State Park Wildlife Loop, plus stops by Mt. Rushmore and the Crazy Horse Memorial. You can run this route hundreds of times and never get bored of it. There is likely more than 500 curves on these routes, including three of the only corkscrew bridges in the world on Iron Mountain Road. Whether riding a true veteran bike or a more modern machine, the roads are rewarding. Along the route we had ample bison viewing and lunch set with table clothes and china at the State Game Lodge. I made several navigation errors and my buddy and I racked up a few extra miles, hitting 160 for the day.

Day three promised several roads new to many riders, including Rockerville Road and Vanocker Canyon Road. Both were fantastic, flowing roads which showed off the best of the Black Hills. After lunch at a Mexican restaurant, we set off for Sturgis and a stop at the Motorcycle Hall of Fame and Museum. It was considerably warmer in Sturgis than in the hills, so many of us cut our time short in Sturgis and made the 45 mile run back to Hill City. My buddy and I took several detours on the way back exploring different canyon roads. We only added about twenty miles to our day, but they were well worth it. We rolled just over 150 miles for the day. Neither my buddy's Norton, nor my Trident gave an ounce of trouble the whole run and we had a lot of fun wearing the nubs off tires.

Day three ended with the traditional closing banquet and swapping of road stories. It was an another shining time and congratulations to the Black Hills Chapter. And, next year's Western run will be hosted by the Flat Iron Chapter in Estes Park, Colorado the last week of August. I hope to see you out there!

Speedy Safely!

Steve Strohmeier







Vintage Racing with AHRMA - South Beloit, IL - 7/31/26 to 8/2/26

Story and Photos by Cathy Drexler



Alongside the AMCA, the American Historic Racing Motorcycle Association (AHRMA) is another way to enjoy vintage bikes. Wade has raced with AHRMA for a years and this year I took up the role of "sidecar monkey" along with doing photography at AHRMA events.

We recently raced at Blackhawk Farms Raceway with friends from other AMCA chapters, one of whom is from Illinois and recently became a dual-chapter member by joining the Badgers.

A typical AHRMA race weekend starts on Friday with practice sessions to learn the features of the track. For those who are new to racing, there is AHRMA Racing Academy and Sidecar School also held on Friday. Bill Bonow, a new Badger, attended the racing school on Friday, and was able to race on Saturday and Sunday after completing the "mock race" at the end of the day Friday, on his Honda CB 350.

Saturday and Sunday include practice sessions in the morning followed by racing, typically 13 races, with each race having more than one class in it.

AHRMA is special in all the fun that happens off-track, and we have met many wonderful people in the AHRMA paddocks. People are friendly and helpful, happy to share anything from home-cooked food to bike parts and gear.

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Vintage Racing with AHRMA - South Beloit, IL - 7/31/26 to 8/2/26

Story and Photos by Cathy Drexler (Drex)



Ever since my first view of the sidecar racing, it interested me, and this year I had the opportunity to try it, attending sidecar racing school during a hot weekend at Motorsports Park Hastings (NE). It is thrilling and the camaraderie is great.

The photos accompanying the article show Wade (#759, Honda CB 400), Bill Bonow (#476), Nick Ternet (AMCA member in Indiana; #741, Triumph Thruxton), and me as "monkey" on #62x, 1978 Yamaha 400 cc with pilot Rob Himmelmann (sidecar photos by Garrett Hartman, Overshot Media). Bill and Wade raced in the Novice Historic Production Lightweight class, and Bill had a 2nd place finish both days, impressive for a rider who just completed rider school. His years of experience as a mechanic for an auto race team helped, since he knew the track very well.

Rain on Friday and Saturday added to the challenge of the weekend but made for some cool photos!

I would encourage any "race-curious" Badgers to check out AHRMA; it's become a treasured part of our riding calendar, and we are looking forward to racing at Nelson Ledges in Ohio in September and the Barber Vintage Festival in October.

Cathy Drexler (Drex)





Vintage Racing with AHRMA - South Beloit, IL - 7/31/26 to 8/2/26

Photos by Cathy Drexler (Drex)





Vintage Racing with AHRMA - South Beloit, IL - 7/31/26 to 8/2/26

Photos by Cathy Drexler (Drex)









Beer City Cycles Bike Show and BBQ - 6/13/26

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



There are polished bike shows, and then there are real ones. The kind where the bikes are ridden in, the oil is still warm, the kickstands sink into the pavement, and nobody is worried about fingerprints on a gas tank. June 13 in Bay View was exactly that kind of day. The 4th Annual Beer City Cycles Bike Show & BBQ was not some overproduced, fenced-off spectacle built for social media photos and trailer queens. It was a full-on grassroots motorcycle gathering built by riders, for riders, and by the time the smoke cleared, it felt like one of the best days Milwaukee has to offer for anyone who cares about old iron, good people, and the culture that keeps this whole thing alive.

I got there early with the Beer City crew, same as always, while the day was still quiet and the streets had not yet filled with the sound of bikes rolling in. The weather looked perfect right from the jump, and that kind of forecast puts a charge in everybody before the first tent even goes up. But what really made this year different was how smooth the whole thing ran. A week before the show, the crew got together, sat down, and mapped out the day. That little bit of preparation made a huge difference. Vendors got staged without chaos, the street got blocked off clean, and when the motorcycles started coming in, everything was ready for them. Then the floodgates opened.

Throughout the day, more and more bikes packed into the street until every direction you looked had something worth stopping for. Choppers, vintage bikes, performance machines, and newer motorcycles all stacked together in one place, exactly how it should be. Harleys, Indians, Ducatis, we had all of them. Some bikes were clean and sharp. Others looked like they had been hammered on for years and loved every mile of it. That is what made it feel right. It was not about one style, one brand, or one scene trying to outdo the next. It was about motorcycles, plain and simple, and the people willing to ride them in.

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Beer City Cycles Bike Show and BBQ - 6/13/26

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



And people came from all over to do exactly that. Old friends showed up, new friends rolled in, and by the time the day was in full swing, there were riders and supporters from across the Midwest. Chicago, Cleveland, Des Moines, people put in the miles to be there, and that says more than any flyer ever could.

By the end of the day, we had over 300 motorcycles and more than 400 people in attendance. That is a serious turnout by any standard, but it means even more when the event is free and built from the ground up by people who actually care. This show has never been about putting up barriers. It has never been about making motorcycles feel exclusive. It has always been about opening the street up, letting the bikes come in, and giving people a place to hang out, swap stories, look at great machines, and feel like they are part of something worth showing up for.

A huge part of that atmosphere came from Puddlers Hall. The bar staff there were absolutely amazing throughout the entire event. They kept everyone hydrated all day long, and they handled the crowd like total pros. We drank the bar out of several beers, which should tell you everything you need to know about how the day was going, but they kept it moving and never lost their stride. That kind of support matters. A good venue can make an event work. A great one becomes part of its identity, and Puddlers did exactly that.

One of the coolest parts of the day was seeing everybody's reaction to the collaboration beer with Torzala Brewing. People were genuinely fired up on it, and it was a blast watching them crack a can, take a drink, and immediately start talking about it. That kind of thing adds another layer to a show like this. It gives people something tied to the day itself, something made for the event and the people in it. If you missed out on trying it, there may still be a few cans left over at Torzala Brewing in the Lincoln Warehouse, but I would not wait around too long.

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Beer City Cycles Bike Show and BBQ - 6/13/26

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



The food was another hit. Not Bad came ready to work, and they put out amazing food from the start of the day until they finally sold out by the end of it. That is always a good sign. When a food vendor gets cleaned out at a motorcycle show, you know they did something right. People were eating, hanging out, talking bikes, and settling in instead of just passing through. It made the whole event feel less like a quick stop and more like a real all-day gathering. If you missed them at the show, they recently opened up a truck at Bad Moon Saloon, and it is absolutely worth checking out.

Still, the motorcycles were the center of everything. I spent the day doing my best to talk to as many people as possible, shaking hands, checking out bikes, and making lap after lap through the show trying not to miss anything. That is one of the best parts of an event like this. You can walk the same row three or four times and still catch a detail you missed before, a wild front end, a hand-built bracket, a killer paint job, a motor setup that makes you stop and stare, or just the perfect stance that tells you somebody nailed the whole build. The bikes had personality. The people behind them did too.

This year we also changed up the raffle. Instead of a pile of smaller prizes, we went with 12 larger prizes, and that move went over extremely well. It made the whole raffle feel bigger, sharper, and more exciting. More importantly, it helped us raise $2,085 for the In The Wind Foundation, which helps wounded veterans experience the freedom of the open road. That is the kind of thing that gives a motorcycle event real weight. It is not just a party, not just a bike show, and not just an excuse to fill a street with cool machines. It is also a chance to give something back through the same community that has already given so much to all of us.

Continued on next page









Beer City Cycles Bike Show and BBQ - 6/13/26

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



When it came time to judge the bikes, that was no easy job. There were so many machines that could have taken home hardware that it honestly felt brutal trying to narrow it down. I walked around those bikes over and over again, trying to settle on who should win Best in Show, Best Chopper, and Best Performance. Thankfully, I had help from the team, because there is no way one set of eyes could fairly sort through that many quality bikes alone. In the end, Bob's Flathead took Best in Show, Swis won Best Performance with his Shovelhead FXR, and Graves took Best Chopper with his dual front head Shovelhead. All three were deserving, and all three stood out in a field full of serious competition.

But like any proper motorcycle event, the day did not end when the awards were handed out.

After we packed up and cleaned the street, Beer City and Not Bad threw the afterparty over at Bad Moon Saloon, and that is where things shifted from a great show into a full-blown all-night ripper. There was a free keg of beer, DJs going, tattoos happening, and bikes still rolling in long after the sun went down. It kept rocking until 2 a.m!

Then Sunday morning came. Every year, as a thank-you to the community, the Beer City crew does a cleanup around Puddlers Hall, covering about a 1.5-mile radius and making sure any trash from the event, or any trash out there at all, gets picked up. It is not glamorous work, but it matters. If you are going to throw an event in a neighborhood, you have a responsibility to respect that space. Leaving it better than you found it should be part of the deal, and that is exactly what the crew did.

Continued on next page









Beer City Cycles Bike Show and BBQ - 6/13/26

Story and Photos by Chris Gunns



Looking back on it now, I am still blown away by the day. This is and always will be a free motorcycle show. That matters. Motorcycles should be out in the world, ridden and seen, not hidden away under covers or rolled off trailers for a few hours of parking-lot posing. There is something honest about a show that welcomes everybody and asks only that you come out, be part of it, and help keep the culture moving forward.



That is really what makes Beer City Cycles Bike Show & BBQ work. It is not just the bikes, even though there were plenty of incredible ones. It is not just the turnout, even though over 300 motorcycles and more than 400 people is something to be proud of. It is not just the food, the beer, the awards, or the afterparty. It is the people who continue to support it. The sponsors, the vendors, the riders, the friends who travel in, the folks who come to check it out for the first time, and the crew that puts in the work before, during, and after the event. That is what gives it life.



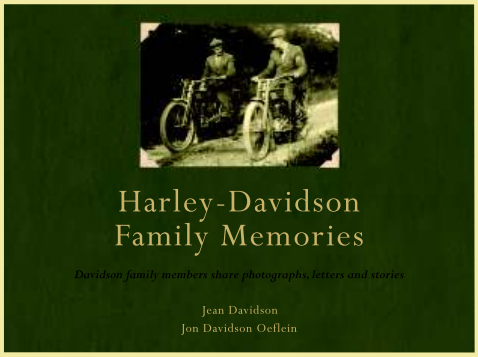
And now the eyes are already on next year.

The 5th annual goes down June 12, 2027, back at Puddlers Hall in Bay View, and the plan is to make it bigger. More room, more bikes, and hopefully additional streets blocked off for more motorcycle parking. If this year's show proved anything, it is that the demand is there and the community is behind it. So if you are reading this and thinking it sounds like something worth keeping alive, that instinct is right. Events like this only happen when people keep showing up, keep supporting them, and keep believing that grassroots motorcycle culture still matters.



Cheers,
Chris Gunns





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Knucklehead Reunion - Milwaukee, WI - 6/16-20/26

Story and Photos by Cathy Drexler (Drex)



It wouldn't be an AMCA event in June without some rain, and the 90th anniversary Knucklehead reunion was no exception. But with Tom Hinderholtz in charge, we knew it would be a great time.

After the meet & greet at Tom's Vagabond Ranch, the assembled riders made a short trek to Paul Woelbing's Carma Labs, where we enjoyed a meal, a look at the bikes doing the 1936 Knucklehead Tour crossing the U.S., and fantastic organ music. What a pleasure to see Bjorn and Katarina from K&B Cycle again!

Wednesday's planned trek took riders along the north shore and on to the Throttlestop Museum in Elkhart Lake and a lunch stop at Racer's Hall in Plymouth. The number of riders shrunk as the predicted hard rain arrived, but a band of committed riders made the trip on 2 wheels, joined at the venues by those of us who chose the 4-wheeled option. Racer's Hall put on an excellent lunch, greatly enjoyed by those who had been out in the rain & wind for hours.

Continued on next page.





Knucklehead Reunion - Milwaukee, WI - 6/16-20/26

Story and Photos by Cathy Drexler (Drex)



The next day was sunny, a perfect day for the ride to Forest Home Cemetery, where we were met by "Walter Davidson" (AKA Badger Heritage President Jon Davidson) with some fascinating history, and a few choice words to say about the choppers! Afterwards Johnny Daney and Anna Maria hosted a group of us with a tasty meal eaten in the shade of their backyard overlooking Lake Michigan. The day was completed by an evening spent at the H.D. Museum's Bike Night.

All of this led into Saturday's Wild Ones Weekend at the museum, featuring a Knucklehead parade led by a police escort over the Hoan Bridge, group photo, antique bike show, and (hopefully a new tradition) the kick-start contest, at which Anthony Pozza distinguished himself by making it into the final two.

A memorable weekend, thanks to Tom Hinderholtz and everyone else who helped make it happen.

Cathy Drexler (Drex)





Knucklehead Reunion - Milwaukee, WI - 6/16-20/26

Photos by Cathy Drexler (Drex)





Knucklehead Reunion - Milwaukee, WI - 6/16-20/26

Photos by Cathy Drexler (Drex)







Harley-Davidson: The Interwar Years

Story by Matt Miller



With the end of WW1 came new challanges for the military. The country had had enough of war and with this new frame of mind a major drawdown was about to happen. Money tightened up and so did contracts for new equipment. The military had to do with less or what it had and relied on those 20,000 J models it had even surplusing many to police and civilian use. With a spray of paint, many Js went from olive drab to "Brewster Green" by 1920. A small modification yet maybe the earliest beginning of "Chopper" bikes possibly?



US Army Olive Drab



Post war Brewster Green

After WW1 Harley Davidson became the largest motorcycle manufacture in the world. With this, the company expanded its civilian and corporate footprint. The post war era introduced the iconic teardrop gas tank shape and brought about richer paint schemes that moved the brand away from its utilitarian wartime look. The J was manufactured till 1929, when the new flathead 45 was introduced. The new model bringing about alot of attention especially overseas was the VL 74 CI motorcycle.



The Army kept expirimenting with the new Harley models but with new noteriety and dealerships expanding around the world other countries became interested in the new form of military transportation. One such country was Japan, who initially imported Harley-Davidson motorcycles directly. In 1924, the company Toyo Kogyo (the future company Mazda) would try to manufacture a copy but technical difficulties and its endeavor was unsuccessful.

As the Great Depression caught hold of the country, HD was not spared. Faceing financial strain Harley Davidson licensed the Japanese company Sankyo Seiyaku to manufacture the motorcycles locally using American blueprints and tooling in 1932. An entire engine plant was disassembled and rebuilt near Tokyo to build just the 1200cc VL flathead motor.

Continued on the next page

Harley-Davidson: The Interwar Years

Story by Matt Miller



The domestic machines were later branded as Rikuo and many of the motorcyles supplied the Japanese military. With changing politics and a turbulent relations between countries , production shifted fully under Japanese control into the mid 1930s, eventually operating independent as the Rikuo Internal Combustion Company.



Many of these motorcycles would be used in the conquest of China and Asia proper during Japans military expasion in the 1930s. Ironically US troops would face them soon...

Note many of the motorcycles were with side car and Type 94 machine gun. this was easily done with the 74 CI VL motor, not the 45.

Next chapter will cover us military bikes during the 1930s.







From the Archives - Number 7

Dan Krause - Chapter Historian



25 years ago… How often have you heard that phrase? Unfortunately, this year, it has a historical significance that is attached to a tragic event in our nation's history, 9/11. I'm sure all of us are remembering that day, where you were, how you felt etc. This remembrance made me think about what was going on with our chapter back in 2001, so I dug through the archives and thought I'd share the good things and happy memories we all share in our hobby through our memberships to the AMCA and our beloved Badger Heritage Chapter…

The Spring Meeting was held at President Tony Hueltner's home, March 19, 2001.

The club Treasury was $729.00.
Our other chapter officers were:
Jack Heisler – VP
Roger Klopfenstein – Secretary,
Garry Engel – Treasurer,
Newly Minted Newsletter Editor Chris Bilda,
Jack Heisler – Nat'l Judge,
Jim Campbell – Road Captain
Mike Lange – Chapter Historian.

Meeting discussions were centered around planning for the Summer Picnic, Chapter T-shirts and sponsoring a National Road Run! It would be another 14 years later until our chapter held our 1 st National Road Run in Elkart Lake, WI at the Osthoff Resort, great memories there!

The Summer Meeting was held a member Willie Kiefert's shop in Hartford, WI on May 20th.

Much of the discussion was centered around the planning for the Summer Picnic to be held on Saturday, June 30th at Kewauskum Park on the river. Al Feyereisen and Tony Hueltner planned the food, Ed Feyereisen prepped the field games and Greg Pagel made the field games trophies. There wasn't any documentation of the field games results but there was a mention of Dave Durler's "stunt driving" prowess which thrilled the crowd! No one was hurt…

The Fall Meeting was held at Russ Scharrer's home in Allenton, WI.

Russ and his brother Steve along with their wives Lucy and Heidi prepared an early "Thanksgiving Dinner" for everyone, it was excellent! Elections were held and we elected a new VP Jared Millen to replace Jack Heisler who served as VP for six years. Jared served as VP for the next two years and then serve as our President for four more years after that.

Willie Kiefert brought in samples of the looooooong awaited club t-shirt which sported the vintage winged AMC Logo. I still have mine! (pic next page).

A committee was formed to prepare the chapter to become involved with the Harley 100th celebration chaired by Jared Millen along with Jim Campbell, Tony Hueltner and Chris Bilda.

Planning for the Winter Dinner at Anderson's on Friess Lake has started as well. The Winter Meeting will be held in January and hosted by Jerry Johnson at the Eagles Club in Fort Atkinson.

Willie Kiefert hosted his first "Open House & Swap Meet" at his shop in Hartford on December 1st . Many Badgers were in attendance. Parts and money changed hands along with lots of "Good Fellowship"!

Well, there you have it, 25 years ago in our chapter's history! Have a great fall riding season, ride safe and enjoy the fall colors!



From the Archives - Number 7

Dan Krause - Chapter Historian





Spokesman Stories

Calling All Members!

I am always looking for more content for the Spokesman newsletter.

I know many of you attend various events and take photos and have a story to tell. I see the photos on Facebook all the time and just wish you could send at least a dozen of those photos to me with a short story about the event. We would all like to see and hear what our memebers are doing.

I will no longer ask individuals for photos and a story as I would like to leave it up to them if they choose to send anything or not.

If you need help with your story I can help and will always do a punctuation and spell check of the stories and may edit them a little as well.

Thanks! Newsletter Editor - Steve Peters

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